

THE
COMMUNICATIONS
AND ELECTRONICS BRANCH

95 CRAFTSMAN BOULEVARD
CFB KINGSTON, ONTARIO, K7K 7B4



BRANCHE
DES COMMUNICATIONS
ET DE L'ÉLECTRONIQUE

95 CRAFTSMAN BOULEVARD
BFC KINGSTON, ONTARIO, K7K 7B4

1000-5 (Br Adjt)

20 January 2021

Distribution List

BRANCH ADVISORY COMMITTEE

RECORD OF DECISIONS – WEDNESDAY, 20 JANUARY 2021

RECORD OF ATTENDANCE

POSITION / APPOINTMENT	RANK & NAME
Chair / Branch Leader	Brigadier-General James Lambert
Co-Chair / Branch Advisor	Colonel Eric Charron
Member / Colonel Commandant	Brigadier-General Kevin O'Keefe (Retired)
Member / Branch Chief	Chief Warrant Officer Gilles Philibert
Member / General Officer	Lieutenant-General Frances Allen
Member / Director Signals	Colonel Yannick Lemieux
Member / Strategic A6	Colonel Nick Torrington-Smith
Member / Comd CFIOG	Colonel Mark Parsons
Member / Reserve Rep	Brigadier-General David Awalt
Member / IM Group Rep	Brigadier-General Patrice Sabourin
Member / Home Station Cmdt	Lieutenant-Colonel Walter Gamblin
Member / Home Station RSM	Chief Warrant Officer Rob Sherman
Member / IM Group Chief	Chief Warrant Officer Robert McCann
Member / RCCS Chief	Chief Warrant Officer Carson Roberts
Member / ATIS Tech STA	Chief Warrant Officer Kelvin Turriff
Member / CFIOG Chief	Chief Warrant Officer Shawn Mailer
Guest / MOSID Rep	Master Warrant Officer Jon Moberly
Guest / MOSID Rep	Master Warrant Officer Jodi Jones
Guest / MOSID Rep	Master Warrant Officer Dany Vallerand
Secretariat / Branch Adjutant	Major Blair Christie

ITEM	DISCUSSION ITEMS	ACTION ITEMS
01	INTRODUCTORY REMARKS 1. Branch Advisor – Introduction: Confirmed BAC – Council, <u>not</u> Committee. Invites extended to wider range of MOSIDs, NCMs, and Comd Teams. Waiting on new CDS direction to confirm mission and scope for cyber / SIGINT. 2. Branch Leader – Introduction: Appreciation extended. Moving issues forward now requires remote access. CURSIT straining families, elders, and children. We are all overwhelmed. Mass Branch involvement is BL’s priority.	1. Nil. 2. Nil.
02 03	REVIEW PRIOR ROD / REVIEW BAC ToR AND REAFFIRM BAC AND SENATE-LEVEL PROBLEM-SETS 1. Branch Advisor – Prior RoD: Key take-away items are con’t Branch Governance, SOPs, BSO, and Strat Outlook (focus on events). Concerning Governance: strong focus on finalizing the framework: ToRs for Senate, BAC, Museum BoD, and NCM Council. Branch SOPs ongoing. Branch Standing Orders (BSO) are complete. Strat Outlook process is complete. 2. Colonel Commandant – BAC ToR: The Senate is the head of the family (serving, retired, museum reps). Plan is to present BAC ToR to Senate to endorse (such as approve the membership of the BAC found on ToR – page 3).	1. Nil. 2. HS Cmdt: Replace ‘Cmdt’ with the ‘Home Station Cmdt’. Branch Chief: Liaise with CMs and confirm C&E CWOs currently holding Tier 1 and 2 appointments so we can include them in BAC RoD Distr List and Next BAC meeting.

04	BATTLEFIELD STUDY TOUR SITREP 1. Colonel Commandant – Update: Finances sorted. Approx. \$93,000 to be returned to the Foundation for a future tour (and restricted to BF Study Tour use only). \$21,000.00 of the \$93K is earmarked for specific units / persons. Br Adjt is returning funds to all units / pers who requested. Recommending scaled down scope for future trips (LGen Allen offered sp for any trip to Europe). <i>What Next:</i> We made a decision not to have 2021 tour, now must decide upon 2022. Log Branch are going forward. If Yes – potentially \$38,000.00 credit available, but lost if not used in 2022. If we do this, entire Branch must rally & support and we must scale down the proposed event (2020 was too grandiose). The plan / scope / scale must apply to all future tours, not just 2022 (thus create a skeletal plan of what any tour would look like). The role of the Foundation in such heritage events (reunions, HRH visit, tours, etc.), in fund-raising requires a MoU that clearly outlines the Foundations role in managing / safeguarding tour \$\$\$.	1. Col Cmdt: Draft MoU. Col Cmdt / BA: Seek input and consensus on support for 2022 Tour. Engage with FE / OAs. Seeking interest for numbers, participation, and scope of activity. Col Cmdt to liaise with HCol and retirees Br Adjt: Close out Refund Plan.
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	The key message is three fold: 1. Fin reconciliation for NL 20 is complete. 2. We need to make a decision on 2022 soon. We need BAC endorsement, and more importantly, the Branch leadership must get behind the decision and support. 3. We need a planning team established ASAP and recommendations on time / scope to be brought forward – likely for Senate decision in March – this might include a scaled down version of 2020 tour.	
05	BRANCH VISION & MISSION STATEMENT 1. Branch Advisor – Direction: What is the commonality that unites us, regardless of theme or event? Can we encapsulate this in writing? Can we make a vision statement and mission that resonates with the Branch and / or the C&E Family? 2. Colonel Commandant – C&E Family Mission: Family Mission found in ToR. Consider that we are bigger than the Branch and must think of the Family holistically ... think of a C&E <i>Family</i> mission / vision.	1. Br Cols & CWOs: Discuss / devise a Mission & Vision for BL's signature. Ensure it is nested in the C&E Family context. 2. Br Adj: Draft letter for Distr. Include annexes (draft Credo, Grad Charge, and msn / vision).

06	C&E WEEK 2020 RECAP / C&E WEEK 2021 REVIEW 1. Branch Advisor – 2020 Recap / 2021 Review: Points from 2020 to take-away ... Virtual venue does have the vantage of greater involvement as fin / event restrictions have typically focused event to NCR-Kingston. Virtual means is the new normal and will be heavily leveraged. Furthermore ... ▪ OAs ... avoid Br topics during their environmental-specific gatherings; ▪ Indoc Course ... Slow to generate interest (need leadership to get the numbers up sooner). Plan is to hold former POCs as 1st right-of-refusal to lead the next programme and build upon request (may change roles, such as swapping officer and WO); ▪ Exercise NOBLE SKYWAVE ... N/C, a success story, continue to build upon event, absorb AAR points, and leave CFJSR as POC; ▪ PD Brief (Association) ... Discussion panels (5G, GoC, tour exp) was excellent. Considered a crowning event (200+ points of connection);	1. BA: Change Branch to <i>C&E Family Update</i>. BA: ID advanced timing on when to go virtual, and ETA on virtual events, so that units may initiate RFC/RFS processes install VTC, etc. Col Cmdt: Maintain contact with HCol net and continue to have them involved. OAs: Less duplication in presentations. ALCON: Submit C&E 2021 theme. CO Museum suggests <i>perseverance</i>. ALCON: Keep C&E Week to four (4) days. No Fri. Do not start too early to account for time dif.
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	▪ Branch Update ... H&A, CAF J6 address, never topped 50 x points of contact. Leverage physical presence of Indoc course & local units as much as feasible + Br Leadership. Broaden to <i>C&E Family Update</i> (beyond serving community as speakers) and get retired members involved as they are interested in museum, OA briefs, event summaries, H&A, etc.; and ▪ Tech Support (CFSCE) ... Maintain CoA conduct dry-runs. CFSCE remains POC. Please record briefs for Reserve access (timings do not align).	
07	MUSEUM SITREP 1. Branch Advisor – Museum CURSIT: Museum is still closed off, no access for visits, scaling back in capabilities, and staff conducting virtual work. Branch Leadership is establishing a Museum BoD (Reps incl. retired, Foundation, Branch, serving mbrs). And would provide oversight on day-to-day committee. BoD to provide direction & guidance to committee who seek clarity on tasks, priorities, and activities. CFIOG is <u>loaning</u> us a vacant Class B position for 3 years to establish a REO for OC Museum. Thus far, we have 1 x interested officer. Position shall work with Museum Mgr.	1. BA / HS Cmdt: BA for SLA with CFMWS and HS Cmdt for SLA with Base.

	SLA in the works with Base Commander to guarantee a tier of base support (funding, infrastructure). SLA with CFMWS to provide framework with Museum NPP employees. 2. CO Museum – Museum SITREP: In addition to OC Museum (serving under Cmdt), we are pursuing Home Station Staff Officer (HSSO) (advertised differently on REO). REO pushed across the Army; not a lot of attraction. Position can mature online presence. 3. On the PSP side – Frank Clayson moving on (regional PSP appt). Other retirements on PSP side. A chance to re-energize new relationships with PSP / museum. 4. Museum closure ... Rotational staff. Not open to visitors. Museum Ops ongoing ... DCM efforts benefits from this (purchased <i>Past Perfect</i> archiving tool) and are able to move collection online. Archive Access improved via Museum / CMCEN sites.	2. BA / CO Museum: Raise discussion points to 25 Feb 21 BoD Mtg: a. DCM SITREP b. Subscription Fees c. P070 = DCM access
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08	FINANCIAL UPDATE 1. Branch Adjutant – Branch Funds Review: Health of the Branch Fund is good. We typically request \$20-\$25,000.00 annually and deplete the entire amount. This year, we still have nearly \$16,000.00 remaining and all accounts are healthy. Tentative request this year will be for \$500.00 (\$400.00 earmarked for H&A and \$100.00 for Distress Signal Fund). Most events suspended or cancelled outright. Review of account holding needed before official ask is raised. 2. Colonel Commandant – Foundation Review: 80% of Foundation funds goes to the Museum (most of which is for salaries). Changing focus requires CRA / legal liaison, but a certain amount of money must go directly to the Branch to keep the account healthy. Foundation = fin crunch. Outreach is important. 3. What can we do to generate more money? ▪ Focus on P070 donation reinvigoration (or thru Canada Helps and / or United Way targeted donations). ▪ Discuss with Reserve community: can't donate to P070; what can be done? ▪ Why donate? What are the benefits (see marketing brochure – <i>why should you care</i> theme). ▪ Admission Fees to museum access? ▪ Re-Start Mallock Trophy and other related competitions.	1. Br Adjt / BC: Review Branch funds, plan out expected costs, and devise CoA for funding strategies and get some feedback. Br Adjt / BC: BL to promote Foundation Fundraising Campaign when Marketing Brochure ready to go <i>live</i> with a cover letter. Co-ord Br Adjt & Col Cmdt. 2. ALCON: Receive and push museum brochure.
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09	ENVIRONMENTAL BRIEFS 1. Director Signals, Strategic A6, Comd CFIOG: See attached slide decks.	1. Nil.
10	COLONEL COMMANDANT SELECTION SITREP 1. Colonel Commandant – Replacement SITREP: Application with DSA. Expected to take more time (summer / autumn). General O’Keefe’s tenure concludes 22 May 21. Will remain on until replacement – BGen Robidoux – is officially in.	1. Nil.
11	STRATEGIC OUTLOOK OVERVIEW 1. Branch Adjutant – Strat Outlook Overview: System in effect. Key Branch Events are organized and prepared. Branch holds a list of major events celebrated by the founding services. CMCEN and SP have a method to submit an event to the Branch for fin support and Branch Representation. Visit CMCEN or the Branch SP Site. All events currently cancelled or postponed; if events are launched, Branch Staff will reach out to unit leadership in search of OPIs and provide tech / fin / planning support.	1. OAs: Share any virtual events so that we can publicize them on CMCEN vice regular live events for foreseeable future.

12	OPEN FORUM / ROUND TABLE / Q&A 1. Branch Advisor – Discussion Items: Cyber Blog concept for upload on CMEN. APPROVED for release. OPIs and Branch Staff will work together to upload, and popular feeds can be leveraged to provide future C&E Week PD topics. <i>Cyber lift</i> paper to be considered as potential briefing topic during C&E week with LCol Jodoin as facilitator. For CMCEN BLOG – Col Dave Yarker will be initial custodian of this monthly BLOG. BA has informed IM GP Communication Group for potential to expand readership / interest on this BLOG. Col Cmdt informed that Foundation was looking to cooperate with Museum to underline Museum’s 25th anniversary in May ’21 – shaping / scoping to be refined <u>before</u> details are shared via CMCEN and other Branch channels.	1. Nil.
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13	CLOSING REMARKS 1. Branch Leader / Branch Advisor – Next BAC: Planned for next September 2021. 2. Colonel Commandant – Boyd Birthday: John Boyd, signalman and oldest Canadian Veteran, turns 108 on Tue, 26 Jan 21.	1. Nil. 2. Nil.
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RECOMMENDED BY:

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ERIC 414

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J.P.E. Charron
Colonel
Branch Advisor

APPROVED BY:

LAMBERT, JAMES
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D.J. Lambert
Brigadier-General
Branch Leader

Encl: 1